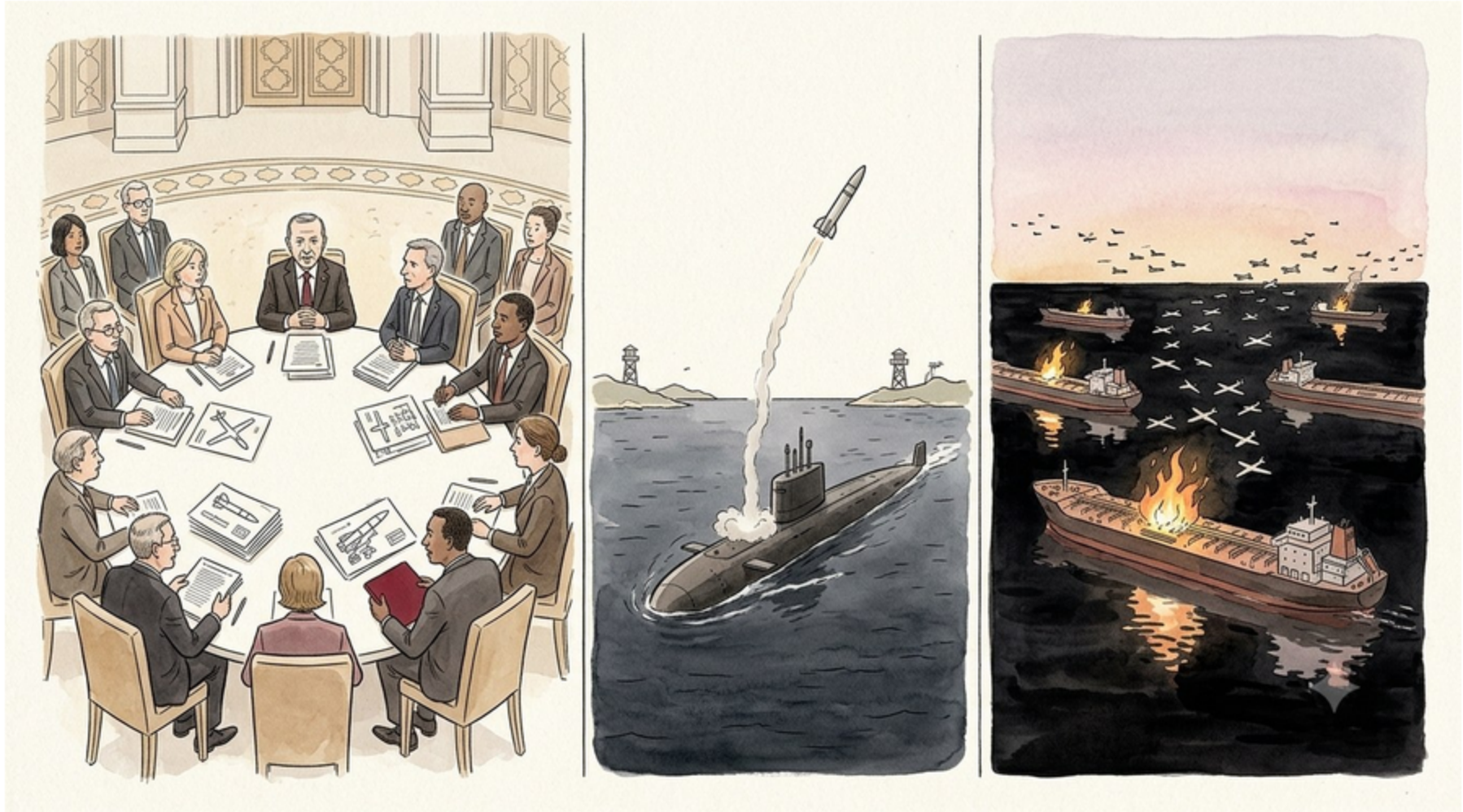


Defense Brief

July 10, 2026



NATO's Ankara Summit Delivers \$50B in Defense Deals, China Tests SLBM in the Pacific

The Bottom Line

The NATO Ankara summit delivered tangible defense industrial outcomes: \$50 billion in procurement deals, a \$40 billion drone initiative shaped by Ukraine's combat experience, ATACMS production shifting to Germany, and Patriot licensing for Ukraine. But the summit's achievements sit against a darker backdrop — China demonstrating a mature SLBM capability that advances its nuclear deterrence posture, Russia's drone industrial base pivoting toward NATO-war planning, and Ukraine's air defenses stretched to the breaking point with Patriot production at least two years away. The gap between NATO's spending commitments and actual delivery remains the alliance's persistent vulnerability: only five of 32 members meet the core defense spending target, and the alliance's counter-drone investment, while unprecedented, must catch up to a threat that is already being weaponized at scale.